



HOTHOUSE VEGETABLES



In countries with cool climates, usually there is not enough heat to grow the most delicate or exotic vegetables. But in special hothouses, with glass or clear plastic walls, a farmer can grow almost any crop. This is because the temperature inside a hothouse can be controlled. Hothouses are useful in warmer countries, too. They mean the farmer does not have to follow the seasons of the year, and summer vegetables that do not store can be grown fresh all year round.



Nature's "hothouse"

Some of the world's hottest spots are dry deserts. But if a water supply can be set up, the desert heat can be put to good use. Fertile gardens can be created, like this fruit orchard in Jordan.



Computer controlled

Tomatoes are quite fragile plants, so this hothouse, where the temperature and feeding are controlled by a computer, is a good place to grow them. Tomatoes grown in hothouses are usually top quality and are picked by hand.



Short showers

Most of the work in large hothouses today is done by machines. These young sweet pepper (capsicum) plants are watered by overhead pipes. Hothouse crops must also be sprayed to protect them from the pests and molds that like the damp, warm conditions.